

LESSON SIXTEEN

TOPIC: MODESTY

TEXT: PHILIPPIANS 4:5, 1 PETER 3:3-4

MEMORY VERSE: 1 PETER 3:4 But let it be the hidden man of the heart, in that which is not compatible, even the ornament of a meek and quiet spirit, which is in the sight of God of great price.

CENTRAL TRUTH: Moderation encompasses more than merely refraining from excess; it involves achieving the appropriate balance in every aspect of life.

INTRODUCTION: Engaging in moderation is a commendable practice. In fact, self-control is among the virtues that the Holy Spirit cultivates within the life of a believer. It is essential to instruct our children and fellow believers to assertively say "no," as this reflects the importance of moderation. Reflect on Proverbs 6:9-11, which states, "Even sleep is necessary, but excessive sleep results in poverty." There are defining elements in our lives; primarily, your demeanor when you possess nothing and secondly, your demeanor when you possess everything. Strive to live a life of contentment, free from external influences dictating your existence.

Lesson Outline

1. The hidden man of the heart: 1 Peter 3:1-4

Our physical form represents our outward man, our soul embodies our expressed, manifested self, and our spirit signifies our hidden man. Our adornment should

consist of the qualities of meekness and a tranquil spirit—these are of great worth and cherished in the eyes of God. This does not denounce external adornment but rather encourages us to take pride in the richness of our inner selves. Isaiah 61:10
~ Genuine submission promotes soul-winning without the need for disputes or extensive preaching: 1 Peter 3:1.

2. REASONS FOR MODERATION:

- i. Moderation aids us in achieving equilibrium across various facets of our lives (Philippians 4:5).
- ii. Moderation prevents extremes, fosters restraint, and is associated with self-control (Galatians 5:22-23).
- iii. At times, even beneficial things can become obstacles if utilized without moderation (1 Corinthians 8:9).
- iv. Embracing moderation enables us to practice self-discipline (1 Corinthians 9:25-27; Acts 24:16).

CONCLUSION:

When we fail to live in moderation or lack self-control in specific areas of our lives, it signifies that we are not permitting God to fully enter those domains. Those aspiring to succeed in the pursuit of eternal life must exercise temperance in all matters and conduct everything in moderation (1 Corinthians 9:24-27).